

A CAPABILITY FORMATION EXPERIENCE

Stay or Leave?

Live Career Growth Assessment

The Capability Position Read

Read the Position Before You Make the Move

FREE GUIDED ASSESSMENT • 60 MINUTES



Temidayo Afonja

Founder, The Density Group
Author, The Capability Audit

The question underneath the question

A fair question, and a reading that sits upstream of it.

WHAT YOU CAME IN ASKING

**“Should I stay in this role,
or should I go?”**

WHAT YOU NEED TO READ FIRST

**“Is this work still building me,
and what would still travel if
the context changed?”**

The first question is yours alone. The second sits upstream of it, and this session can read it more rigorously.

What this read will and will not do

This read will not tell you to stay or leave.

IT WILL

Give you a defensible reading of your current position and one category of move your evidence supports testing.

IT WILL NOT

Predict layoffs, diagnose your employer, or make an employment decision for you.

YOUR SCORES

Stay private. Nothing is submitted, collected or shared at any point.

THE RECORDING

The teaching runs to minute 50 and is recorded. The last ten minutes are live questions and are not recorded.

This is not legal, medical, financial, immigration or mental-health advice.

DEFINITION ONE

Density

Learning velocity. Whether this environment is still forming you.

Density is whether the environment is still building capability in you. It is a property of your conditions, not your effort. A role can be exhausting and form nothing.

Density is not motivation, hours, pressure or effort. It is whether the work is still teaching you something you could not do ninety days ago.

Six statements measure it. You will score them in a moment.

DEFINITION TWO

Optionality

Career portability. Whether what you built travels.

Optionality is whether the capability you are building would be recognised and valued somewhere other than here. It is about translation and exposure as much as ability.

A low Optionality score may reflect context-bound capability, weak translation, limited exposure, or a combination. It is not a verdict on ability or worth.

Six statements measure it. Same scale, same window.

Your initial read: statements 1 to 3

Density. Live, silent. 1 strongly disagree to 5 strongly agree.

- | | | | | | | |
|----------|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | In the last ninety days I have been handed a problem I did not already know how to solve. | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
| 2 | I work close enough to people who are better than me that I can watch how they think. | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
| 3 | My work is reviewed by someone who can tell the difference between good and adequate, and who says so directly. | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |

No evidence line yet — that is deliberate.

Your initial read: statements 4 to 6

Density, continued. Same window, same instruction.

4

The feedback I receive changes what I do next, not just how I feel.

1 2 3 4 5

5

I regularly operate at the edge of my competence rather than the comfortable center of it.

1 2 3 4 5

6

Looking back six months, the work I do now would have been genuinely hard for me then.

1 2 3 4 5

No evidence line yet — that is deliberate.

INITIAL READ

Your initial Density reading

Add statements 1 to 6.

INITIAL DENSITY TOTAL

_____ / 30

19 to 30 is high
6 to 18 is low
17 to 21 is the boundary band

Hold the number. Do not share it.

A total inside 17 to 21 sits on the boundary. It does not resolve to high or low — you will read both neighbouring states rather than pick one.

Your initial read: statements 7 to 9

Optionality. Same scale, same window.

- | | | | | | | |
|----------|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 7 | The capability I am building would be valued by an employer in a different industry. | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
| 8 | I can describe what I do in terms of outcomes, not just my company's internal language. | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
| 9 | If my role disappeared tomorrow, the capability I built would still be mine to carry. | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |

No evidence line yet — that is deliberate.

Your initial read: statements 10 to 12

Optionality, continued. Last block of the first pass.

- | | | | | | | |
|-----------|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 10 | People with the power to hire or advance me, inside or outside my company, can already see what I am good at. | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
| 11 | What I am learning is a transferable capability rather than a company-specific procedure. | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
| 12 | I could rebuild a strong position somewhere else within a year. | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |

No evidence line yet — that is deliberate.

INITIAL READ

Your initial Optionality reading

Add statements 7 to 12.

INITIAL OPTIONABILITY TOTAL

_____ / 30

19 to 30 is high

6 to 18 is low

17 to 21 is the boundary band

Hold the number. Do not share it.

A total inside 17 to 21 sits on the boundary. It does not resolve to high or low — you will read both neighbouring states rather than pick one.

The four states

Density crossed with Optionality. Your state helps you see a form of exposure your job title cannot.

DENSITY / HIGH

DEPTH TRAP

Deep expertise fused to one context.

COMPOUNDING

Deep capability that travels.

DENSITY / LOW

STAGNANT

The work stopped asking more of you.

FRAGILE

Options on paper, not enough depth beneath.

OPTIONALITY: LOW AT LEFT → HIGH AT RIGHT

FIRST PLACEMENT

Place yourself. Privately, and provisionally.

Cross your two numbers, then rate your confidence in the placement from 1 to 5.

1 Cross Density and Optionality

Two totals, one square. If either total sits inside 17 to 21, mark it boundary instead of picking a square.

2 Rate your confidence from 1 to 5

Write the number privately. You will compare it against your confidence after the evidence pass.

3 Hold it lightly

This is a first read, not a finding. State is not identity — it reads conditions in a ninety-day window, and it moves.

No one is asked to share a square. Nothing is collected.

The evidence protocol

This is what your second reading has to survive.

Every corrected score requires an evidence line from the last ninety days. Every score, in both directions.

A 4 OR 5

At least one clear positive instance from within the window.

A 3

The mixed or inconsistent pattern. A 3 is a reading, not an absence of one.

A 1 OR 2

What repeatedly happened instead, a counterexample, or no qualifying instance in the window.

A ?

Cannot support it either way? Write your most defensible number and add one question mark: 3?, 4?, 2?

A 3 means mixed. A question mark means unsupported.

Three ways a self-score goes wrong

Run all three against your first numbers before you rescore.

1. SCORING THE INTENDED LIFE

"My rotation was approved last month. Statement 1 gets a 4."

The window is the last ninety days of work that happened — not work that was approved, promised or planned.

2. CONFUSING VALUED WITH FORMED

"Three VPs ask for my read before anything ships. Statement 3 gets a 5."

Being relied on is real. It is not the same as being developed.

3. READING LOW OPTIONALITY AS A VERDICT

"Statement 10 is a 2 because I am not senior enough."

A low Optionality score may reflect context-bound capability, weak translation, limited exposure, or a combination. It is not a verdict on ability or worth.

Three is the set. Run them, then rescore.

Score all twelve again

Evidence in both directions. Do not change your first number.

THE PROTOCOL, IN SHORT

4 or 5	one clear positive instance	3	the mixed or inconsistent pattern
1 or 2	what happened instead, or no qualifying instance	?	most defensible number, marked once: 3?, 4?, 2?

Density 1 · 2 · 3 · 4 · 5 · 6

Optionality 7 · 8 · 9 · 10 · 11 · 12

Write the corrected number and a short evidence phrase under it. Your first number stays where it is. Phrases, not essays — twelve minutes for twelve statements.

Workbook pages 5 and 6.

Re-total before you place again

New numbers. A fresh placement, not a review of the first one.

DENSITY, CORRECTED

_____ / 30

OPTIONALITY, CORRECTED

_____ / 30

19 to 30 high · 6 to 18 low · 17 to 21 is the boundary band, and it overrides both

Total the axis using the numbers exactly as you wrote them. A question-marked score counts as its number.
Rate your confidence in the corrected placement from 1 to 5.

When the evidence remains uncertain

The neighbouring-score sensitivity check. An operational convention, not a statistical confidence interval.

NONE

No unsupported-item sensitivity range is required.

Use the corrected total normally, subject to the boundary band.

1 OR 2

PROVISIONAL — RUN THE NEIGHBOURING-SCORE SENSITIVITY CHECK

- Total the axis using your numbers exactly as written.
- Total it again with every marked item one point lower, then again one point higher.
- Bounded inside the 1 to 5 scale — a 1? is never tested at 0, a 5? never at 6.
- If the sensitivity range includes any total from 17 to 21, do not force a state. Hold the axis as boundary.

3+

INCOMPLETE — do not place on that axis today. Incomplete is a legitimate reading, not a failure.

ONE axis in the 17-21 band: read the two adjacent states the OTHER axis selects.

BOTH axes in the band: record Boundary and assign no single state.

Your corrected position

Privately placed, provisionally held.

1 Place your corrected square

Or mark boundary, or mark the axis incomplete. All three are legitimate readings.

2 Rate your confidence from 1 to 5

Compare it with the confidence number from your first placement on workbook page 3. The comparison is private.

3 Keep both readings visible

The first number and the corrected number sit side by side. The distance between them is the finding.

A position you can defend with evidence is worth more than a position you feel confident about.

What each state costs

Four states. One immediate cost to notice in each.

DEPTH TRAP

Value is deep but context-bound.

COMPOUNDING

A strong current position still requires renewal.

STAGNANT

Neither axis is accruing.

FRAGILE

What travels today is no longer being renewed.

This is the short reading. The fuller cost of your own square, including the hidden cost, the cost of waiting, and the false reassurance that keeps you there, belongs in deeper follow-on work.

Seven categories of move

Direction, not a plan. Your evidence helps you choose which category to test.

1	Remain and deepen	The formation conditions are real and worth protecting.
2	Translate what is built	The capability exists. The language for it does not.
3	Widen exposure	The work is good and the wrong people have seen it.
4	Test portability	Find out what travels before you need it to.
5	Repair formation conditions	Change the work, not the employer, first.
6	Prepare for exit	Your evidence gives you reason to prepare in case the conditions do not repair.
7	Seek an external perspective	High stakes, incomplete evidence, or a boundary position.

No square prescribes a category. Your evidence and constraints still apply.

The Next-Move Note

Three lines. Yours, private, and enough to act on.

MY CURRENT READ

My position appears to be: _____

State / boundary / incomplete

WHAT I NEED TO TEST

The category of move my evidence supports testing is: _____

One of the seven categories.

WHAT HAPPENS NEXT

One action, conversation, or piece of evidence I will pursue next is: _____

One thing. Something you could begin this month.

This is a note, not a decision. It records what your evidence supports testing next.

Choose How You Want to Continue the Read

Your read is complete. What you need next depends on what is still unresolved.

1

I have enough for now.

Take your Next-Move Note and act on it.

Nothing further is required. The session was built to be complete on its own.

2

I want to keep working privately.

Continue with the Capability Formation Field Kit.

You understand your reading and want a structured system you can return to on your own.

Different unresolved needs require different levels of support.

This session gives you a guided reading. The Field Kit gives you a system you can return to.

TODAY'S GUIDED READ

- An initial and evidence-backed reading
- A provisional position
- One move category to test
- A written Next-Move Note

Complete on its own.

CAPABILITY FORMATION FIELD KIT

- Fuller state-cost work
- A repeatable private evidence process
- Structured rescoring as conditions change
- A system you own and return to

EXPLORE THE FIELD KIT

temidayoafonja.com/fieldkit



The shipped kit



Use the Field Kit when you want to keep reading the position without needing another live session.

BEFORE YOU GO

You have read your position. The move is the next conversation.

Put a rescore date ninety days out before you close your notes. When your reading changes, notice what changed. Share it only if you choose.

Capability Formation · Temidayo Afonja · The Density Group

Questions & Applications

Ten minutes. The recording has stopped.

“I can help you clarify what your evidence supports. I cannot make the employment decision for you.”

WELCOME

Statement interpretation · the evidence protocol ·
boundary and incomplete readings · move-
category distinctions · what to investigate next

OUTSIDE THE BOUNDARY

Telling someone to stay or leave · predicting
layoffs · legal, medical, financial, immigration or
tax questions · diagnosing an employer · asking
for scores, states or employer names

Close at 60:00.